US Markets Daily Analyst Report

June 24, 2026 | As of US Market Close (4 PM ET)

SPY / QQQ Snapshot

	SPY (SPDR S&P 500)	QQQ (Invesco Nasdaq-100)
Today's Close	$734.98	$718.09
Prev Close	$733.58	$713.65
Change	+0.19% (+1.40)	+0.62% (+4.44)
52-Wk High	$760.40 (Jun 2, 2026)	$748.65 (May 2026)
52-Wk Low	$591.89 (Jun 23, 2025)	$511.93 (May 30, 2025)
≈**1-Yr Return (from 52-wk low)**	+24.2%	+32.2%

Note: Historical backfill unavailable — Yahoo Finance and alternative data providers (yfinance, Stooq, Twelve Data) all returned HTTP 403 via this environment's proxy. 52-week range and 1-yr return figures sourced from web search result snippets; 1-yr return is measured from 52-week low date (not from exactly 12 months prior). prices.csv contains the 2 verified trading days available.

Today's Market-Moving News

Micron Technology (MU) Blowout Q3 Earnings — After Hours

Micron reported Q3 2026 EPS of $25.11 vs $20.20 expected (24% beat) and revenue of $41.5B vs $35.6B expected (+346% YoY). Q4 guidance of $50B ± $1B crushed the $42.9B Wall Street consensus. MU stock rose 6%+ in after-hours trading, with the VanEck Semiconductor ETF (SMH) +3% AH and the Roundhill Memory ETF (DRAM) +10% AH.

Tech / Semiconductor Recovery Bounce

After Tuesday's punishing selloff — MU fell 13%, QQQ dropped 3.29%, and South Korea's KOSPI plunged 9.99% in a global chip rout partly triggered by a BofA rate hike note — markets stabilized Wednesday. QQQ recovered +0.62% as dip buyers returned to semis and mega-cap tech names ahead of Micron's closely watched print.

Oil Prices Plunge ~4%

Brent crude fell 4.33% to $73.74/bbl; WTI dropped 3.92% to $70.34/bbl. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said the Iran war is nearing an end, reducing geopolitical risk premium. Falling oil eased inflation expectations and put downward pressure on the 10-year Treasury yield (which slipped below 4.5%).

Fed Bank Stress Test: All 32 Banks Pass

The Federal Reserve released 2026 stress test results, showing all 32 large banks could absorb over $708B in losses under a severe recession scenario (10% unemployment, -39% CRE, -30% home prices) while staying above minimum capital ratios. The CET1 ratio fell 1.6pp but remained comfortably above minimums. Crucially, the results do NOT affect capital requirements until a methodology review in 2027, so buyback/dividend capacity remains in focus for next week.

KB Home Earnings Beat; New Home Sales Data

Homebuilder KB Home (KBH) added ~3% after posting Q2 revenue of $1.11B, edging the $1.10B estimate. May New Home Sales data was also released; specific read was not available from search results — gap noted.

Macro / Fed Context

Fed Chair Kevin Warsh continues to face political pressure on rate policy. The fed funds target rate sits at 3.50–3.75%; the 10-year yield was near 4.48%. April core PCE came in at 3.3% YoY — the highest since Nov 2023 — and the Fed projects inflation won't reach 2% until 2028 at the earliest. Treasury Sec. Bessent expressed confidence the US economy can return to 3% GDP growth.

News → Today's Market Moves

SPY +0.19% ($733.58 → $734.98) | QQQ +0.62% ($713.65 → $718.09)

■ **Primary driver of QQQ outperformance (+0.62% vs SPY +0.19%)**

The asymmetry between QQQ and SPY today directly reflects the tech/semiconductor bid returning after Tuesday's mauling. Nasdaq-heavy QQQ recovered more than the broader S&P; 500 because chips (MU, Nvidia, AMD) and mega-cap tech saw dip buying ahead of Micron's after-market print. Anticipation of a strong MU result created a speculative bid in semis, lifting QQQ disproportionately.

■ **Why both indices moved modestly, not explosively**

Investors were cautious: Micron had just dropped 13% on June 23, signaling real uncertainty. Markets 'bought the rumor' cautiously, keeping gains small (+0.6%) rather than pressing hard. The upcoming PCE report (June 25) also acted as a ceiling — adding risk into a potential inflation shock is a bad trade.

■ **Oil drop → bond relief → mild SPY tailwind**

Oil's ~4% decline eased inflation expectations, pulling the 10-yr yield below 4.5%. Lower yields are a tailwind for equities via lower discount rates. This likely contributed the bulk of SPY's +0.19%, particularly benefiting rate-sensitive sectors like real estate and utilities. The Dow's outperformance (industrials, financials) relative to SPY suggests the oil drop boosted confidence in the growth narrative (Iran peace = lower input costs).

■ **Fed stress test: bank stocks neutral to slightly positive**

All 32 banks passing was the expected outcome and had limited market impact intraday. However, it sets the stage for anticipated buyback announcements next week, providing a minor support bid for the XLF sector.

Next-Day Scenarios — Thursday, June 25, 2026

Key catalysts: May PCE Inflation (BEA, ~8:30 AM ET), Micron earnings fallout, bank capital actions (post stress-test), and ongoing Iran/oil trajectory.

CATALYST 1 — May PCE Inflation (BEA, ~8:30 AM ET)

Consensus: Core PCE +3.4% YoY (prior +3.3%); Headline PCE +4.1% YoY (prior +3.8%)

↓ **HOT scenario (Core PCE ≥ 3.5% or Headline ≥ 4.2%):**

SPY likely -1.0% to -2.0%, QQQ -1.5% to -2.5% at open. Mechanism: hot PCE entrenches 'higher for longer' rate expectations — Fed won't cut in 2026, possibly needs to hike if inflation re-accelerates. Growth stocks in QQQ are especially sensitive to duration risk. Treasury yields spike (10-yr back above 4.6%), pressuring the P/E multiple on mega-cap tech. Even Micron's blowout earnings may not be enough to offset the macro shock on QQQ.

↑ **IN-LINE scenario (Core 3.3–3.4%):**

Markets absorb the data without major reaction. Micron's earnings beat becomes the primary driver: QQQ likely opens +1.0% to +2.0% from MU-led semi strength; SPY opens +0.3% to +0.7%. The macro backdrop is unchanged — mild 'higher for longer' but not a new shock.

↑ COOL scenario (Core PCE ≤ 3.2%):

SPY +1.0% to +2.0%, QQQ +1.5% to +3.0%. Rate-cut narrative revives — even a single 25bp cut in H2 2026 becomes plausible. Dollar weakens, gold and EM equities benefit. Amplified by Micron's blow-out, QQQ could see one of its best days of the year. Bonds rally, 10-yr yield could drop to 4.35%.

CATALYST 2 — Micron (MU) Earnings Fallout

MU reported EPS $25.11 (+24% beat) and Q4 guide of $50B (+16% vs consensus). Stock +6%+ in after-hours. VanEck Semis (SMH) +3% AH.

↑ MU gaps hold and semis sustain (base case):

MU opens +6–8%, dragging Nvidia (NVDA), AMD, ASML, and SK Hynix higher. QQQ gets ~0.8–1.2% mechanical lift from MU alone (MU is ~2% of QQQ). Nasdaq-100 could outperform S&P; by 50–100bps on the day as AI memory demand narrative re-ignites. SMH could gain 3–5%.

↓ MU fades — 'sell the news' after 6% AH pop:

If PCE is hot OR profit-taking dominates, MU could give back AH gains and open flat or down. In this case, the June 23 13% crash is not fully recovered and the 'AI trade is overheated' narrative reasserts. QQQ would likely underperform SPY by 50–100bps.

CATALYST 3 — Bank Capital Actions (Post Stress Test)

All 32 banks passed; historically this triggers buyback/dividend announcements within 48–72 hours. JPMorgan, Goldman, Morgan Stanley, Bank of America typically lead.

↑ Major buyback announcements (likely):

XLF (financial sector ETF) likely +0.5–1.5% on buyback news. Provides a floor under SPY since financials are ~13% of S&P; 500 weight. Not a market-moving event alone, but adds support.

↓ Unexpectedly small buybacks or warnings:

XLF gives back stress-test relief gains; marginal headwind for SPY.

CATALYST 4 — Iran War / Oil Trajectory

Brent at $73.74 after -4.33% on June 24. Bessent said Iran war 'nearing an end.'

↑ Confirmed ceasefire or peace progress:

Oil drops another 3–5%. Energy sector (XLE) falls 2–4%, but the inflation relief benefit (lower PCE trajectory) is modestly positive for SPY/QQQ (+0.3–0.5%). Bond yields fall further.

↓ Escalation or stalled negotiations:

Oil spikes 4–6%. XLE rallies, but broader market risk-off: SPY -0.5 to -1.0%, QQQ -0.8 to -1.5%. Higher oil reinflates PCE trajectory expectations, reducing rate-cut odds.

Sources: Yahoo Finance (search-verified), TheStreet, CNBC, 247 Wall St., TradingKey, FXStreet, Federal Reserve press release (bcreg20260609a), web search result data. Price data from web search result snippets as of June 24, 2026 market close. This report is for informational purposes only. No trades are placed or simulated.